

THE CAPTURE OF TUNIS

Holy Roman Emperor Charles V, who was also king of Spain, organized regular campaigns against the Muslim states of North Africa to try to curb the depredations of Christian shipping by Kheir-ed-Din and other Barbary corsairs. In 1535, Charles led a force of 60,000 soldiers, with a Genoese fleet commanded by Andrea Doria, to take the port of Tunis. The Spanish held on to a base at Tunis until 1574, when it was recaptured by the Ottomans.